NETFLIX GLOBAL TOP 10

Earlier-season promotion around new-season releases

Candidate timing, series patterns and test priorities
Evidence from 10 selected launches in Netflix’s global Top 10

Data analysis portfolio

BUSINESS QUESTION & APPROACH

Identify earlier-season promotion opportunities

BUSINESS QUESTION

When could Netflix promote earlier seasons around new-season releases to increase TV viewing hours?

OPPORTUNITY

Do older seasons appear?

Assess older-season Top 10 presence around 10 sampled new-season launches.

TIMING

When is activity concentrated?

Compare candidate promotion periods with other weeks in the same 24-week observation.

TARGETING

How should promotion vary?

Check series-level timing patterns and compare previous vs. earlier seasons.

Business objective: incremental TV viewing hours. Chart patterns generate hypotheses; randomized tests must verify lift.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Test launch-window promotion, with series-specific checks

Candidate periods	Start with −1 to +5 weeks for all-at-once and −1 to +10 for split releases. Both show >50 pp higher chart presence than other weeks.
Tailor the approach	Check each series' timing pattern. Current evidence does not support a universal priority for previous vs. earlier seasons.
Validate incrementality	Randomize added older-season promotion vs. business as usual; measure weekly TV viewing hours per randomized user.

Recommendation: run controlled promotion tests before scaling.

Scope: 10 selected launches across 6 series. Windows come from the same sample; Top 10 presence is not promotion lift.

DATA INTRODUCTION

Weekly Top 10 data support a 10-launch analysis

5,480
TV chart records

274
reporting weeks

10
sampled launches

Source record: one chart-listed TV title/season × report week

Component	Definition	Analysis role
Source & scope	Global weekly Top 10; English and non-English TV	5,480 TV chart records
Selected sample	10 launches across 6 series; 14 distinct older seasons	21 observations, counted per launch
Primary measure	Weekly Top 10 presence; unlisted seasons remain included	Chart visibility, not viewing volume

Coverage: 4 Jul 2021–27 Sep 2026. Absence from a complete Top 10 chart does not mean zero viewing.

PROMOTION OPPORTUNITY: EARLIER SEASONS

Older seasons chart around all 10 sampled launches

10 / 10 sampled launches

At least one older season listed in 24 weeks

21 / 21 observations included

Each season is counted separately per launch

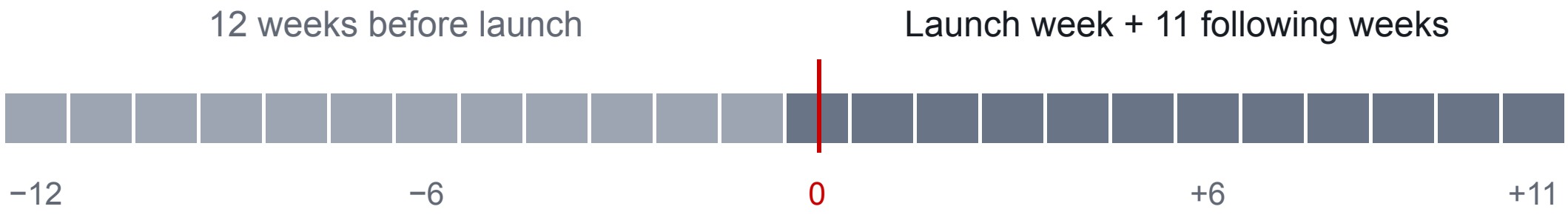
Counts are per launch: the same older season is counted again for each new-season release.

Release format	Launch events	Older seasons identified	Included in analysis	Excluded from analysis	No Top 10 listings (still included)
All-at-once	4	5	5	0	0
Split release	6	16	16	0	1
Total	10	21	21	0	1

Example: Squid Game S1 is counted separately around the S2 and S3 releases.
Bridgerton S2 around S4 is included despite no Top 10 listings in any of the 24 weeks.

21 launch-specific observations cover 14 distinct older seasons. Coverage is limited to the available season list; no listing does not mean zero viewing.

Observe each launch over the same 24-week period



Launch week

Week 0 contains the first release or first episode batch.

Older season

A lower-numbered season from the same series.

Complete charts

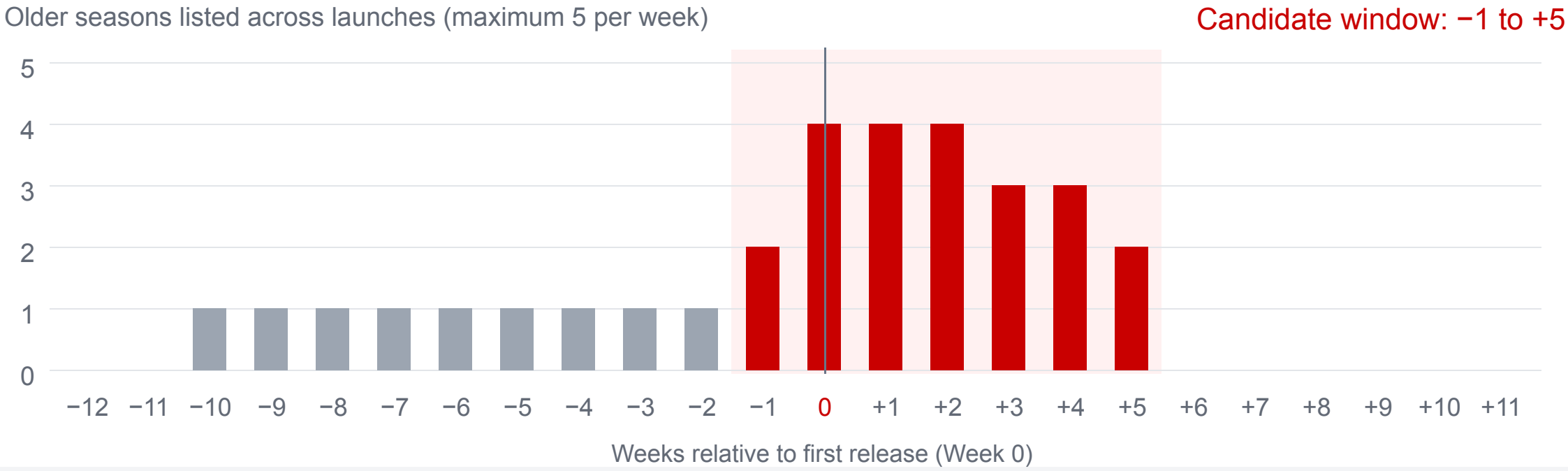
All 24 category charts contain ranks 1–10.

Example: 2 older seasons listed around one launch = 2 observations that week

The timeline aligns releases; it does not measure promotion effects. Later batches can also affect older-season listings.

All-at-once: a candidate window spans −1 to +5

Only Ms. Rachel S1 charts in Weeks −10 to −2.
Squid Game S1 reappears in Week −1; pooled listings peak in Weeks 0 to +2.

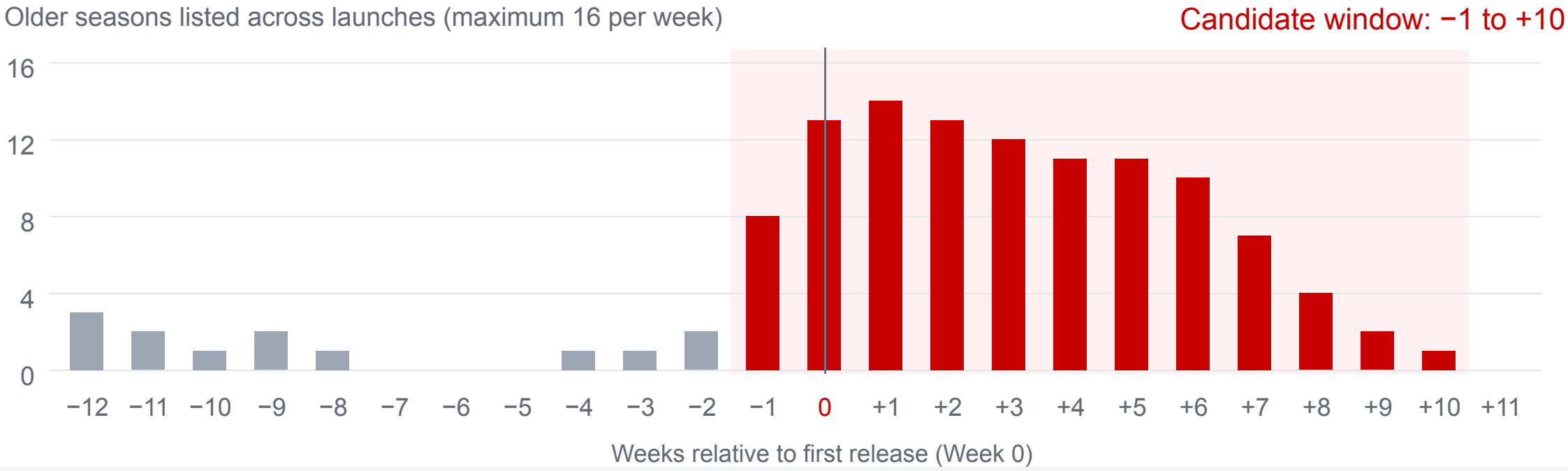


Test added promotion in Weeks −1 to +5; this observed window is not a proven optimum.

Source: Netflix global Top 10; 4 selected launches and 5 older-season observations, counted per launch. Shading = candidate window.

Split-release listings peak at +1 and extend to +10

Listings rise from 2 in Week −2 to 8 in Week −1 across the sampled launches. Activity peaks at 14 in Week +1 and continues through Week +10.

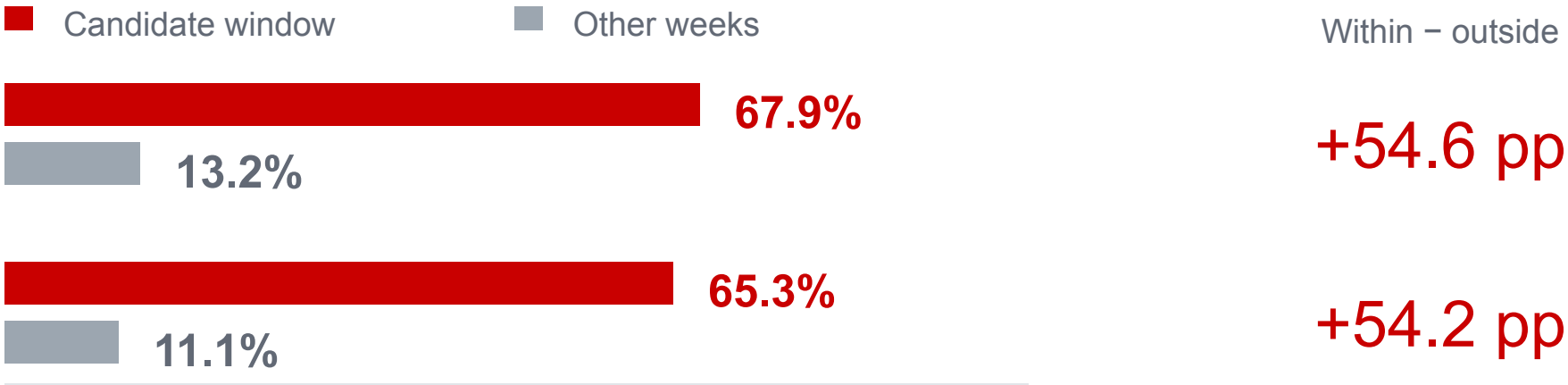


Test Weeks −1 to +10; this range follows observed activity rather than an optimized cutoff.

Source: Netflix global Top 10; 6 selected launches and 16 older-season observations, counted per launch. Shading = candidate window.

Candidate windows show >50 pp higher chart presence

Event–weeks with at least one older season in the Top 10 (%)



Each launch contributes one yes/no result per week; multiple older seasons listed still count once.

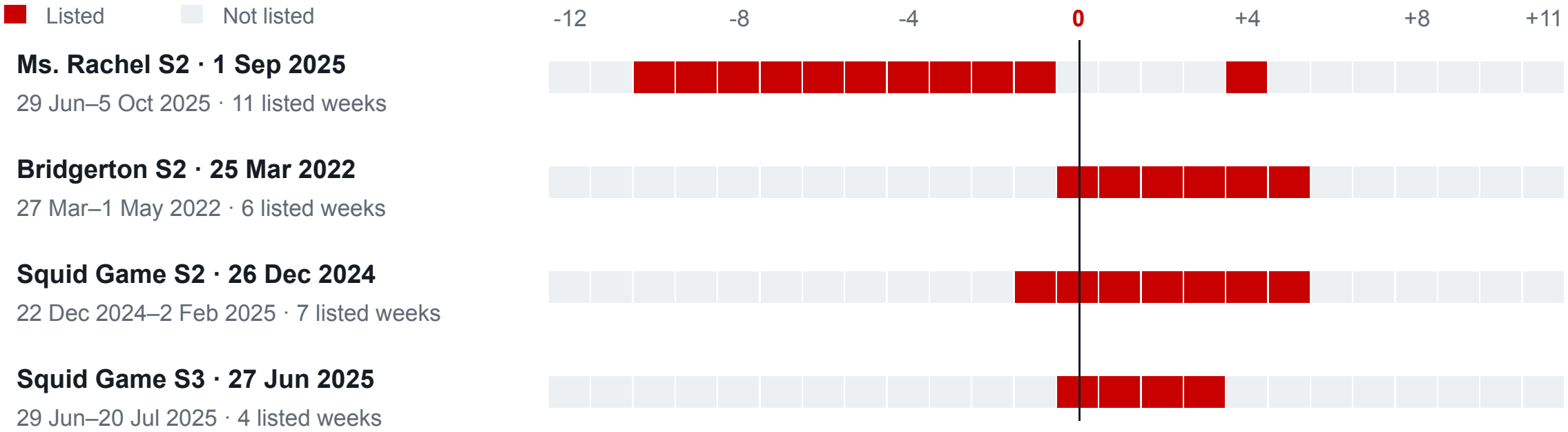
Release format	Candidate window	Inside window	Other weeks	Difference (percentage points)
All-at-once	−1 to +5	19/28 = 67.9%	9/68 = 13.2%	+54.6
Split release	−1 to +10	47/72 = 65.3%	8/72 = 11.1%	+54.2

Windows were selected from this same sample: descriptive concentration, not independent validation, optimal timing or promotion lift.

SERIES CHECK: TIMING VARIES

Ms. Rachel suggests a different promotion-timing hypothesis

All-at-once releases; each row tracks any older season in the same 24-week event window.



Dates show first/last listed report-week ends within each window; spans can contain gaps. Week 0 contains the release.

Check each series' timing pattern before applying a launch-window promotion plan.

Full snapshot: Ms. Rachel S1 charts in 26 of 75 first-to-last weeks, with a 38-week gap. Stable year-round viewing is not established.

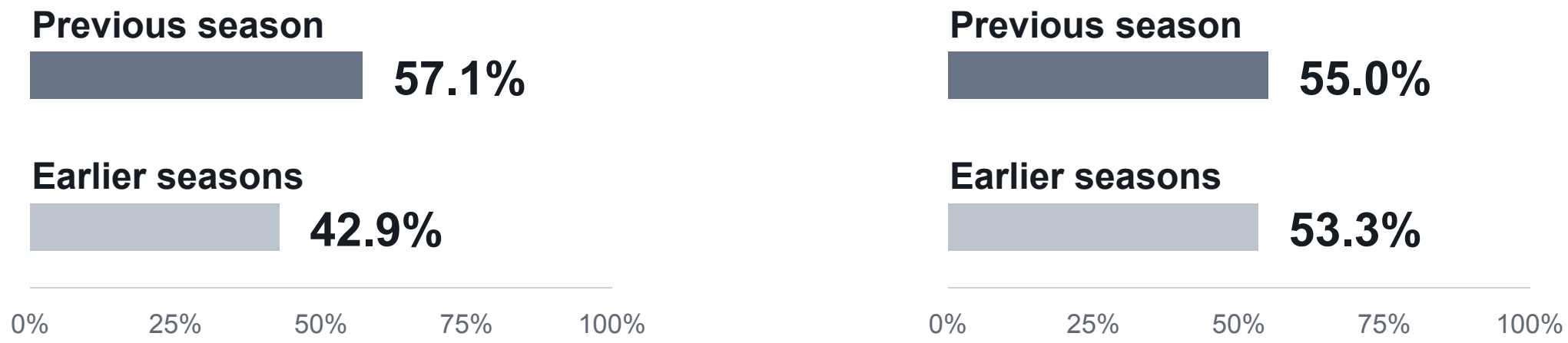
SECONDARY ANALYSIS: WHICH SEASONS?

Current evidence cannot prioritize one season group

All-at-once (n = 1 launch)

Split release (n = 5 launches)

Mean share of candidate-window weeks in Top 10 per season



−1 to +5 weeks | Squid Game S3

−1 to +10 weeks | 3 series

Split releases: +1.7 pp on average; paired launch results vary (next slide).

Previous = immediately preceding season; earlier = seasons before it. Average within each group, then weight launches equally.

SUPPORTING EVIDENCE: SEASON COMPARISONS

Split-release gaps vary by launch, averaging +1.7 pp

All-at-once: −1 to +5 (1 event); split: −1 to +10 (5 events). Only launches with both groups are included.

Release format	Launch event	Previous season	Earlier seasons (mean)	Earlier count	Gap (pp)
All-at-once	Squid Game S3	57.1%	42.9%	1	+14.3
Split	Bridgerton S3	66.7%	66.7%	1	+0.0
Split	Bridgerton S4	25.0%	16.7%	2	+8.3
Split	Manifest S4	8.3%	25.0%	2	-16.7
Split	Stranger Things S4	91.7%	83.3%	2	+8.3
Split	Stranger Things S5	83.3%	75.0%	3	+8.3

Split releases: 3 positive gaps, 1 tie and 1 negative; the mean does not establish equivalence.

Gap = previous − earlier (pp). Shares use listed weeks per season; earlier seasons are averaged within each launch. Launches are weighted equally.

LIMITATIONS

Top 10 patterns identify hypotheses, not promotion lift

Selected sample	10 launches across 6 series, with repeated series; findings do not represent the full Netflix catalog.
Chart threshold	Below-chart viewing is unobserved. A season absent from the Top 10 can still attract viewers.
Window selection	Candidate periods come from the same sample; the comparison describes concentration, not independent validation.
Season targeting	Both groups exist in only 1 all-at-once and 5 split launches; no general season-group priority is supported.
Causal interpretation	Later batches and other events may affect listings. Randomization is needed to measure promotion lift.

Seasons absent from the available season list cannot be counted. Candidate windows are not established optimal promotion periods.

RECOMMENDATION: RANDOMIZED PROMOTION TEST

Test incremental TV viewing before scaling promotion

Decision	Proposed test
Timing	All-at-once: −1 to +5 weeks; split release: −1 to +10 weeks.
Comparison	Added older-season promotion vs. business as usual, within each format.
Assignment	Randomize eligible users; define eligibility using internal data.
Primary metric	Weekly TV viewing hours per randomized user.
Secondary check	Total viewing hours per randomized user, to check substitution.
Season selection	Keep previous vs. earlier season targeting exploratory.
Scale-up rule	Meet a pre-agreed lift threshold without unacceptable guardrail declines.

Before launch, set eligibility, sample size, duration and success thresholds using internal data. This test measures lift, not optimal timing.